trip to the Himalayan kingdom to attend the SAARC summit. The Bhutanese King again graced the 2010 Convocation ceremony of the Calcutta University and delivered the Convocation address on 5 October, 2010.

Indo-China relations also witnessed certain ups and downs. The Indian President Pratibha Devisingh Patil arrived in Beijing on 27 May 2010 for a six-day visit to China and was welcomed by Chinese Premier Wen Jiabao at the Purple Light Pavilion. She received red carpet welcome as the first Indian Head of the State to visit China in a decade. Both sides discussed bilateral issues pertaining to trade and commerce. Particularly, sources said that Mrs Patil sought China's support for India's bid for the permanent seat in the UNSC. Further, an agreement streamlining the visa formalities of airline staff of two countries by Indian Foreign Secretary Nirupama Rao and Chinese Assistant Foreign Minister Hu Zhengyue during Mrs. Patils's visit to China was signed. A MoU for cooperation in the field of civil services and public administration was also signed between the two.

Prime Minister Manmohan Singh met his Chinese counterpart Wen Jiabao at Hanoi on the sidelines of ASEAN Summit. The controversial issue of stapled Chinese visa to Kashmiris and Sino-India economic ties were the core issues of the talks. This was the first top-level contact since the Sino-India defence exchanges were suspended in July 2010 following Beijing's decision to issue such stapled visa to India's Northern Area Commander Lt-Gen B.S. Jaiswal. The two sides agreed to work out solutions to the "difficult" problems, and Wen Jiabao's visit to India in December 2010 would be an effort to find ways to cooperate and collaborate, as there was enough space in the world for both the countries.

Premier Wen Jiabao's arrived in India on a three-day visit on 15 December, 2010. Before his arrival, the Chinese envoy to India stated that relations between the two countries are "fragile and can be damaged easily." Thus, Wen's visit can be seen as an effort to shore up "fragile" Indo-China relations. But the focus of the Chinese delegation was more on economic issues of trade and commerce rather that China's support for India's candidature for the permanent seat in the UN Security Council or Pakistani support of terrorists. The issue of stapled visa was, however, brought up by Wen and it was